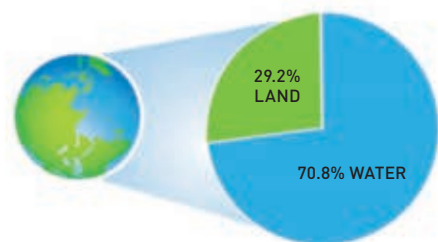


Our physical world

Most of Earth's surface is covered in water. The rest is occupied by seven vast landmasses, called continents: Europe, Africa, North America, South America, Asia, Australasia/Oceania, and Antarctica. The tilt of Earth's axis and its orbit of the Sun means that some places are much hotter and drier than others.

SURFACE AREA

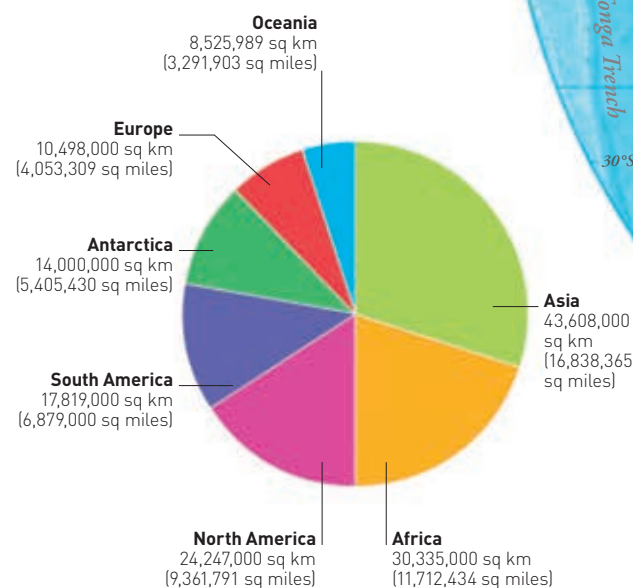
The entire surface of the Earth is 510,066,000 sq km (196,937,000 sq miles). Water makes up more than 70% of the surface area, most of which is salt water in the oceans.



THE CIRCUMFERENCE OF THE EARTH AROUND THE EQUATOR IS 40,075 KM (24,901 MILES)

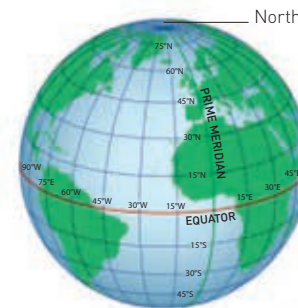
CONTINENT SIZES

Tens of millions of years ago, all land on Earth was joined together in one huge continent called Pangea. Over time, this broke apart and the continents we know today gradually moved to their present locations.



LATITUDE AND LONGITUDE

The equator is an imaginary line that divides the Earth into northern and southern hemispheres. Latitude shows how far north or south a location is in relation to the equator. Longitude gives the east/west position from the prime meridian, which runs between the North and South Poles through London, England.



COORDINATES
Combining latitude and longitude gives every location a coordinate. New York City, for example, is 40.7° N, 74° W.

KEY ELEVATION

